

Boundaries are a sound investment

I mentioned before that boundaries have never been a strong suit of mine, and it's made things really difficult when it comes to protecting my own financial stability and wellbeing.

When we talk about overcoming the need to please other people, boundaries are one of the key resolutions that comes up time and time again. In her book, *Untamed*, Glennon Doyle recalls googling what she should do about her cheating husband, because he was also a great father. She spent hours reading different opinions, but rather than finding it bewildering, she drew empowerment from the conflicting advice. She describes a moment where she realized that, as hard as she tried, she could not do what all of these people thought was best. She could not please everyone, and so she learned to listen to herself.⁹

There will always be people who will think you spend too much on X and not enough on Y. There will always be people who do not understand or agree with how you earn, save, invest and spend your money, and they might not always be strangers on the internet. They might be your close friends and family, people you admire, those with the power to persuade you. So, you have to learn to have the courage of your own convictions, to listen to yourself and trust yourself, all of which we've covered – but these things are impossible to hold on to without properly enforced and upheld boundaries. If you want to focus on your own wellbeing, financial